SCHEDULE MANAGEMENT PLAN

Project Title:	Mary's Consulting – New Company Website	Date Prepared:	May 11, 2026

Schedule Methodology

The project will use the **Critical Path Method (CPM)** for schedule development. Activities will be defined from the WBS work packages, sequenced using precedence diagramming (PDM), durations estimated using analogous and expert-judgment techniques, and the schedule baselined after sponsor approval. A predictive (waterfall) life cycle is used overall, with iterative content production within the Content Development phase.

Scheduling Tools

Microsoft Project (firm-standard) is the primary scheduling tool. Schedules will be exported to PDF for stakeholder communication. A simplified milestone view will be maintained in the project status report. Resource availability is tracked in the same tool.

Level of Accuracy

Activity duration estimates will be ±10% during planning and refined to ±5% as the activity nears execution (rolling-wave planning). Contingency reserves of approximately 10% of total duration are held by the PM at the project level for known-unknown risks.

Units of Measure

Activity durations are recorded in **working days** (8-hour days), with effort recorded in **person-hours**. Standard work week is Monday–Friday, U.S. holidays observed. Resources from outside the U.S. (consultants for content) follow their local calendars.

Variance Thresholds

Schedule variance is reported as a percentage of planned duration. Thresholds for action:

- 0–5% behind: monitored, no escalation.
- 5–10% behind: PM develops a corrective-action plan, reports in weekly status.
- > 10% behind, OR any slip to the Go-Live milestone: escalated to the Sponsor (Mary) immediately. Any change to the baseline requires an approved change request.

Schedule Reporting and Format

Weekly: Schedule status section in the project status report — milestones met / missed, upcoming milestones, schedule variance %, top schedule risks.
Monthly: Updated milestone Gantt chart shared with the Sponsor.
Phase Gates: Full schedule review at each phase transition (Design approval, Build complete, UAT complete, Go-Live).

Organizational Procedure Links

This plan aligns with Mary's Consulting's Project Management Office (PMO) procedures: PMO-001 Status Reporting, PMO-007 Integrated Change Control, and PMO-012 Schedule Baselining. The PM will use firm-standard templates for the schedule baseline and milestone reports.

Schedule Updates

Status is collected from team members each Friday and updated in MS Project the same day. The PM reviews the updated schedule, recalculates the critical path, and publishes the weekly status report by end-of-day Monday. The schedule baseline itself only changes through approved change requests; weekly updates reflect actual progress against the baseline.